

IMPLEMENTATION GUIDE

A step-by-step path from deciding to run the unit to your students presenting. Work through the six steps in order. Each one takes well under an hour.

1

Set your fair date first, then work backward

Find your school's OAS regional or district registration deadline. Count back fourteen weeks. That is your week one. Data collection must finish before winter break, so if the arithmetic pushes data collection into January, start the unit earlier rather than compressing it.

2

Pick your grade band and read that module

Grades 5 to 6, Grade 7, and Grade 8 each have a module with a week-by-week schedule. Read only yours. Print the timeline and post it where students can see it.

3

Talk to the other teachers on your team

Show the cross-curricular map to your ELA, Math, Social Studies, and Art colleagues. Ask each to take one column. If nobody can, deliver the Science column and assign the ELA column as writing work; the unit still runs.

4

Get your materials in place

Use the Required Materials and Supplies List. For Grades 5 to 6, order the menu experiment supplies. For Grades 7 and 8, students mostly source everyday materials, but keep a shared bin of basics: rulers, timers, measuring cups, graph paper, tape.

5

Set your four journal check dates now

Put weeks 3, 6, 9, and 12 in your calendar before the unit starts. Announce all four dates to students on day one. Collection dates that move lose their power.

6

Register with FairGame and with ProjectBoard

Contact FairGame for free setup support, judge recruitment, and mentor matching. Complete OAS registration through ProjectBoard once your student list is settled.

MINIMUM VIABLE VERSION

If you have less time than the full fourteen weeks, run this: topic selection, hypothesis, design approval, three trials, one graph, a display board, and a practice presentation. That sequence still produces an OAS-eligible project.